

GUIDE TO ASTRAL PROJECTION

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The first issue to be ironed out when discussing the topic of astral projection is: What exactly is meant by the term astral projection? How does astral projection relate to out-of-body experiences or just a really good visualization?⁸⁰

THE ASTRAL WORLD

Most things viewed in the astral world have a direct counterpart in the physical world, which you could potentially travel to and verify while in the waking state. The difference between being somewhere in the astral and being somewhere physically is that the astral may contain things which do not have physical counterparts. Emotions don't exist in the physical world despite the fact that their influence can be perceived and even measured. The fact that something which, according to scientific methods, doesn't exist can be observed through its effects only serves to further validate the transcendentalist model. Given that, it should come as no surprise that emotions manifest in the

⁸⁰ For the purposes of this essay, astral projection is assumed to be synonymous with the out-of-body experience.

astral world as physical objects.⁸¹

The astral world can be conceived of as an overlay on top of the physical world. Things exist in the physical because they first became manifest in the astral. Therefore, everything in the physical has an astral counterpart. Usually, the astral counterpart looks no different from the physical. For example, if you project into your living room from your bedroom, everything in the living room should appear exactly as it does in the physical world.

The only caveat is that certain items may appear differently if they have absorbed a large amount of mental energy. This can happen to items over a long period of time in the possession of certain people or through deliberate magical charging. Once a person is adept at astral projection, this can even become a viable method for verifying whether an item is charged as intended. Also note that a charged item may, in some cases, take on a different form in the astral. For example, a twelve-inch charged wand may appear as a five foot long ancient, twisted staff. For that matter, it may even be on fire!

So now two points of difference have been noted between the physical and the astral:

1. Emotions can manifest as visually perceptible items
2. Charged items may have a distorted appearance.

PRACTICAL METHODS

Now, let's focus on a couple of methods for achieving astral projection before revisiting the former point in more detail. I have had success with the traditional form-the-doppelganger-and-transfer-consciousness-to-it method, but it has been described exhaustively in

⁸¹ Only in the higher planes within the astral world.

many other books and can easily be found online. In an effort to be more useful and interesting, this essay will only cover some of the more novel methods of achieving astral projection that I have had success with.

Many people seem to think that astral projection is nothing more than a very well-constructed visualization. They imagine that if you close your eyes and imagine a field of grass and then put yourself there, you are astral projecting. That is, in fact, a legitimate type of projection.⁸² But it has nothing to do with projecting into the astral world, specifically.

The other common confusion is lucid dreaming. That occurs once already fully in the dream state whereas astral projection takes place between sleeping and waking.

One creative way to astral project is to start out with a transcendent visualization⁸³ that includes a mirror⁸⁴. Through that mirror you can see any part of the world you wish. The desired place will appear in the mirror as a bird's eye view.

The visualization in the mirror should be at about 5,000 - 10,000 feet (1,500 - 3,000 meters) elevation, so it should appear more like a map⁸⁵

⁸² See: "The Devachanic World"

⁸³ In other words, a visualization that you can hold so rigidly that you are able to enter into it.

Note that it takes most people months of practice to be able to achieve this state. So, while the method for attaining AP that follows is novel, it is hardly a shortcut compared to other popular methods.

⁸⁴ Any reflective surface will do. For example, a still pond could be used also.

⁸⁵ It may also be possible to get it to work by seeing the destination at ground level, but this has not been the case in my experience.

than as a distinct scene. Once the desired location is present in the mirror, step through it and fall...

If you've ever gone skydiving, you know how it should feel. If you haven't, then this may be somewhat more disconcerting for you. Your heart should leap into your throat as you fall. When you see the ground rushing closer, it should be easy to "lose consciousness" just before you hit the ground. This is a fear response because at this point you're probably questioning just how certain you are that you are actually in projection! However, functionally, this is where the transition in projections is taking place.

At this point, one of two things is likely to happen:

- You find that you are where you wanted to be.
- Your alarm clock will go off⁸⁶ and you'll have to get up and get ready for work.

If you managed to experience the former event, you are now astral projecting!

Another method is what Crowley called, "Eroto-comotose lucidity"⁸⁷. This method requires at least two participants. The person desiring astral projection should be somewhat tired at the beginning of the practice. The traveler is then sexually stimulated by a second person for a sufficiently long period of time until a satisfying climax is achieved.⁸⁸ It is strongly recommended that both parties be familiar with each

⁸⁶ For whatever reason, the transition didn't work and you instead got redirected to a sleeping state.

⁸⁷ Aleister Crowley, *De Arte Magica* (n.p.: Level Press, ca. 1970s), Item 741, Ordo Templi Orientis, U.S. Grand Lodge Library.

⁸⁸ I'm taking the Jason Newcomb route here. Crowley's version warns to avoid orgasm entirely. So, toss a coin... or toss *something* anyway.

other sexually and in good rapport. Once this occurs, the traveler should relax until they begin to fall asleep. At this time the other person should begin the stimulation again. This cycle is to be maintained until the traveler achieves an uncomfortable irritated state. They may begin to itch or feel like they have to get up and move around because they now find it impossible to stay still. When this happens, all stimulation should cease and the traveler must fight through the desire to move and instead achieve sleep. It is in this abnormal state, that an unwilling projection experience is most likely. This situation is considered an unwilling projection because there is no specific indication of a willed destination. This may be desirable because the result may prove to be more useful than if the destination were consciously chosen.

ASTRAL EXPLORATION

Once astral projection is achieved, the first most logical thing to do is center yourself. Realize what is going on and also realize that it's real. After that, explore the properties of this new realm and this new *body*. You cannot take your physical body with you into the astral, as such your consciousness now inhabits the *astral counterpart* of your physical body. This is sometimes referred to as your *astral vehicle*. Glimpses of this body can be seen by people who are able to see "auras". What is actually happening is that the aura reader is half-projecting and seeing your astral self juxtaposed on your physical self. Once you are able to project at will, you will also discover you have the ability to see auras with ease.⁸⁹

One of the first things you'll notice is that the astral body does not behave like the physical body. Instead, the properties of things you see are heavily influenced by your attitude about and preconceptions

⁸⁹ This subject is revisited in "Transcendentalism - Part 2 : What is Astral Projection?"

toward them. For example, a wall is solid if you think it is. If you want the wall to be solid, you can run full-tilt into it and knock yourself down. On the other hand, if you want the wall to be passable, you will pass right through it.⁹⁰ Also, don't hesitate to look at yourself. Mirrors aren't likely to work but you can look at your hands and look down at your body. Note anything that looks abnormal.

The next thing you'll probably want to do is determine or verify your location. Walk around and look for landmarks or other distinguishing characteristics which will help to pinpoint where you are and make note of it. Once that's done, make note of any physical forms around you that appear odd or out of place. If you can visit this place in the physical, make note of your impressions when in contact with the items that appeared abnormal when viewed astrally. As a side note, you may discover that it is impossible to read⁹¹ in the astral. I have failed at every attempt to read anything more than a couple of words.

YOU'RE NOT ALONE

Now that you've laid a foundation for what's going on and have your awareness at a good level, see if there are any other astrally-aware entities in the area. With practice, it is possible to not only sense the presence of other consciousnesses present in the astral plane, but travel to their location instantly!

If this happens to you, one of two things may occur:

1. The other consciousness may remain aloof and you will only detect their presence in a subtle way⁹².

⁹⁰ This concept is revisited in more detail in "Visiting Grandma".

⁹¹ This a well-known property of the astral world. It was even cited as one of the primary reasons why the CIA abandoned astral research.

⁹² For example, you may feel as if you're being watched.

2. They may approach you directly, introduce themselves, and offer their hand.

Also, you may notice strange shadowy forms moving about without acknowledging your presence. These are regular people. They are awake and moving around but are all but oblivious to the astral component of their existence. Interacting with them is not likely to yield any kind of healthy or constructive result.

UNPLEASANTNESS

Up to now, we've dealt with the more pleasant aspects of the astral world. However, given that the physical world is a projection of it,⁹³ it is reasonable that there is unpleasantness as well. As with the rest of this essay, I can only speak about what I've experienced. Other peoples' experiences may vary and *I do not claim that this is an exhaustive list of all possibilities*. With that disclaimer in place, I'll attempt to describe some of the more unpleasant things I've witnessed and how to deal with them.

As mentioned earlier, emotions can manifest as objects in the astral world. If you've taken calculus,⁹⁴ it may be clearer to understand the astral plane as the integral of the physical. In that same way, the physical plane is the derivative of the astral. One thing I cannot piece together is precisely why emotions manifest the way they do or in the astral location they do. I doubt it has anything to do with consciousness of the emotion, since I've had experiences with very subtle emotions which were not in the forefront of my thoughts on the days preceding the projection. Nevertheless, these things happen.

⁹³ From an emanationist perspective.

⁹⁴ If you haven't taken calculus, you can find an alternative metaphor in "Transcendentalism - Part 1 : Essential Concepts"

Good emotions can manifest as easily as bad ones. Yet for some reason, it's the bad ones that seem to take precedence. Take for instance the demon mentioned in my essay, *The Dog-Faced Demon*. From what I've been able to ascertain, it seems that the demon represented certain fears that I had at the time. It was a barrier to accomplishment. It manifested in the astral in the same way that a poet may have described the effect in metaphor. This also leads one to ponder the real importance of metaphors and symbolism in general.

The most important part about the experience was how I reacted. These times are, hopefully, rare. So the decisions you make can potentially have profound effects on your waking consciousness. This is why it's important to establish a clear, confident mindset in relation to the subject. It is only in this way that you will have the confidence, courage, and control to banish any unwanted entities⁹⁵ from your presence. Again, in my experience, I have never encountered anything that didn't flee the moment I willed them to be banished, so I will not presume to give any instruction on what to do if your orders are not obeyed. With luck, I will never be able to provide such counsel.

Another possibility is encountering a malicious sentient being⁹⁶ on the astral plane. This is different from an emotion, because emotions are not sentient. Sentient beings are, have been, or could potentially be human. With the aid of your Holy Guardian Angel (which dwells in yet a higher plane) you have nothing to fear. Without that "big stick", it is conceivable that a sentient being could harm you, though I cannot postulate to what extent.

⁹⁵ The unstated context here is that the entities are unconscious projections from your own mind. These tend to be the manifestations of unprocessed trauma.

⁹⁶ Now we're flipping the switch from things that only exist in your personal perception to things that exist in the common perception of other people.

If you have not yet established *Knowledge and Conversation*, the next best thing to do is to draw a sacred banishing symbol in front of you. This is generally a pentagram for those of us in the western world. It should act as a barrier, but the effectiveness will be largely dependent on your abilities as a magician and the competence of your attacker. If you're obviously in over your head, try to wake up. The being may still exert influence on you in a waking state, but it will not be nearly as potent as when your consciousness is fully in the astral world.

HELP, I'M STUCK!⁹⁷

This brings up another possibility: *Getting stuck*.

There may also come a time when you become so solid in the astral, that it is not clear how to wake or return to your body at will. This happened to me when I found myself tormented by an unseen force. During this particular experience, it felt as if the astral world was losing cohesion. Things were still as solid as they ever were, but impossible things started happening. For instance, the first thing I noticed was that the TV armoire⁹⁸ in the living room - which initially appeared exactly as it really existed - now had a delicate pattern burned into it when I saw it the second time. It is not reasonable to imagine that something happened to the armoire during that time since nobody was in the room. Then I also started noticing other small things changing until it got to a point that I saw two different views when I looked out the window. I had a companion with me that I'd just met in the astral and I told her that something strange was going on with me and that she should leave. She looked confused, but complied with the request. Then I decided that I should wake up.

I tried closing and opening my eyes and willing myself into my body

⁹⁷ IYKYK

⁹⁸ It was a weird piece of furniture people had in the 1990s.

with no luck.

I tried pinching myself and various other little things with no luck.

I was *stuck*.

The house I was in was one story. But when I looked out of a window, I was on at least the ninth floor of what seemed to be a stone castle.

Considering that I was fully aware that I was in a projection state where physical trauma would have no effect on me, but my emotional response to perceived physical trauma might be just what I needed...

I leapt from the window.

The feeling of falling was so vivid that I began to panic, "*What if I'm wrong and this is the physical world!?*" But I was not wrong and I returned to my body an instant before impact.

How did a stable projection suddenly begin to lose cohesion? The most likely scenario seems to be that I was somehow slipping back into a normal dream state. The cause can most certainly be traced to a lack of mental discipline and focus on my part which resulted in a strange hybrid-type experience. Nothing happened to the astral plane, as evidenced by my friend's confusion over my statement. It's very unlikely that she was perceiving anything that I was because nothing objectively changed about the astral world. My problem was entirely localized to my perception of the experience.

CONCLUSION... SORT OF

I hope this has helped to clear up a few misconceptions regarding what astral travel is and how to handle some of the more common circumstances you might find yourself in. I'd also like to reiterate that this essay is not an exhaustive examination of every property of the

astral world or every scenario⁹⁹ you might find yourself in. You'll find many more examinations of the astral world in other essays.

Another important caveat is that the events recounted here are necessarily limited by my ability to comprehend them and as such cannot be taken as universally authoritative. However, your experience should follow the same patterns even if the symbolism varies.

I wish great success on all your astral adventures.¹⁰⁰

⁹⁹ I didn't even talk about the **galactic war** that's going on. But to be fair, I didn't know anything about that when this essay was written.

¹⁰⁰ As I'm annotating this essay in 2025, I realize that it only scratches the surface of what's going on in the astral world. I could write a book just focused on the astral world and I still wouldn't have the nerve to call it 'exhaustive'. Volume 3, perhaps?